personally, but fans of other teams may disagree.) This isn't the kind of event we can imagine repeating an infinite number of times; if nothing else, the basketball players would grow older, which would affect their play. The 2020 NBA Finals will happen only once, and there is a definite answer to who will win, even if we don't know what it is. But professional oddsmakers have no qualms about assigning a probability to such situations. Nor do we, in our everyday lives; we are constantly judging the likelihood of different one-shot events, from getting a job we applied for to being hungry by seven p.m. For that matter we can talk about the probability of past events, even though there is a definite thing that happened, simply because we don't know what that thing was—"I don't remember what time I left work last Thursday, but it was probably between five p.m. and six p.m., since that's usually when I head home."

What we're doing in these cases is assigning "credences"—degrees of belief—to the various propositions under consideration. Like any probability, credences must range between 0 percent and 100 percent, and your total set of credences for the possible outcomes of a specified event should add up to 100 percent. Your credence in something can change as you gather new information; you might have a degree of belief that a word is spelled a certain way, but then you go look it up and find out the right answer. Statisticians have formalized this procedure under the label of *Bayesian inference*, after Rev. Thomas Bayes, an eighteenth-century Presbyterian minister and amateur mathematician. Bayes derived an equation showing how we should update our credences when we obtain new information, and you can find his formula on posters and T-shirts in statistics departments the world over.

So there's a perfectly good notion of "probability" that applies even when something is only going to happen once, not an infinite number of times. It's a subjective notion, rather than an objective one; different people, in different states of knowledge, might assign different credences to the same outcomes for some event. That's okay, as long as everyone agrees to follow the rules about updating their credences when they learn something new. In fact, if you believe in eternalism—the future is just as real as the past; we just haven't gotten there yet—then frequentism is subsumed into Bayesianism. If you flip a random coin, the statement "The probability of the coin coming up heads is 50 percent" can be interpreted as "Given what I know about this coin and other coins, the best thing I can say about the